



- **ARC207/ URB201/ /SOC203**
- **INTRODUCTION TO URBAN STUDIES**
- Spring 2026
- Professor M. Christine Boyer
- Lecture: Wednesday 1:20 – 2:40
- Place: Betts Auditorium
- Precepts: TBA



- Preceptors:
- Mariana Garcia Rendon
- Mayra Monge
- Amelia Mills
- Aerin Washington
- Aonor Washington
- Ariana Borromeo

- The **UN believes that the battle for a sustainable Earth will be won or lost in cities.** Cities can become agents for transforming their relations with the environment. They are the **survival habitats of most of humanity** --- and it is in and through cities that environmental crises will **be managed, mitigated, transformed.**

Many of the world's cities are in **coastal regions** prone to environmental disasters and hazards. They physically experience the dramatic **effects of hurricanes, severe flooding**, in addition to killer **heat waves, parching droughts, runaway wildfires, and pandemics** that other cities suffer as well.



- But will they be able to do so **inclusively, or equitably with resiliency for all?**
- **The concept of the ‘Anthropocene’** assumes the ‘Anthropos’ or man is responsible for changing the earth’s environment and **that ‘we are all in this together’** when not ‘all’ of us are responsible, not all of us share equally the devastations environmental disasters engendered.
- We need **to scrutinize the words we use, the problems we study, the perceptual frameworks we accept as natural** in order to undo the flow of ideas that follow a one-way street from the West to the East, from the North to the South.



Photographer: Hattie Mae Williams

Words Matter: This course takes the most generic, even cliché buzzwords used in the 21st century to describe patterns of urbanization and applies each buzzword to a **specific city**, specifying its localized embodied effects. It is assumed that the generic is indifferent to context, so their application to other cities required sophisticated attention and careful application.

PART I THE STATE OF AMERICAN CITIES in the 21st Century

The City of Sprawl (Los Angeles), Suburbia, and the costs of pro-growth urban economies

The Shrinking City (Detroit), Austerity, right sizing the city, Black Lives Matter

The Resilient City (New Orleans), climate change and the privatization of risk

The Gentrified City (San Francisco), the technological smart city

The Green City (New York), the Environmentally Just City

Part II CHALLENGES TO CITIES OF THE GLOBAL SOUTH

The Informal City (Lagos), how to house and employ the rising urban population

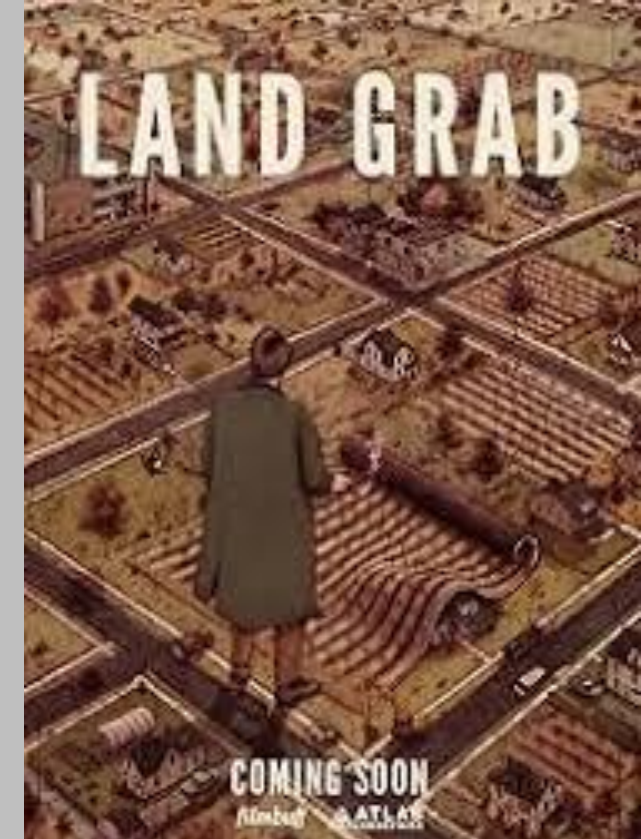
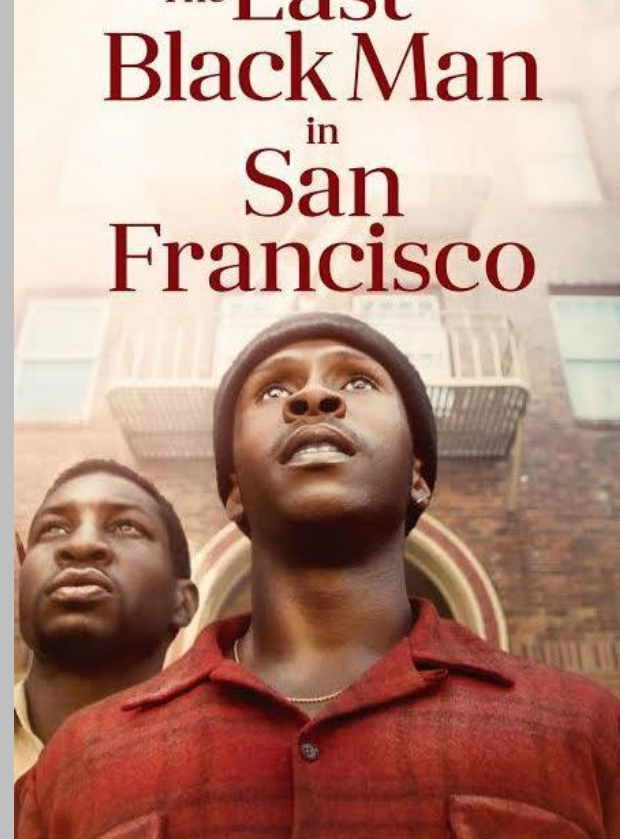
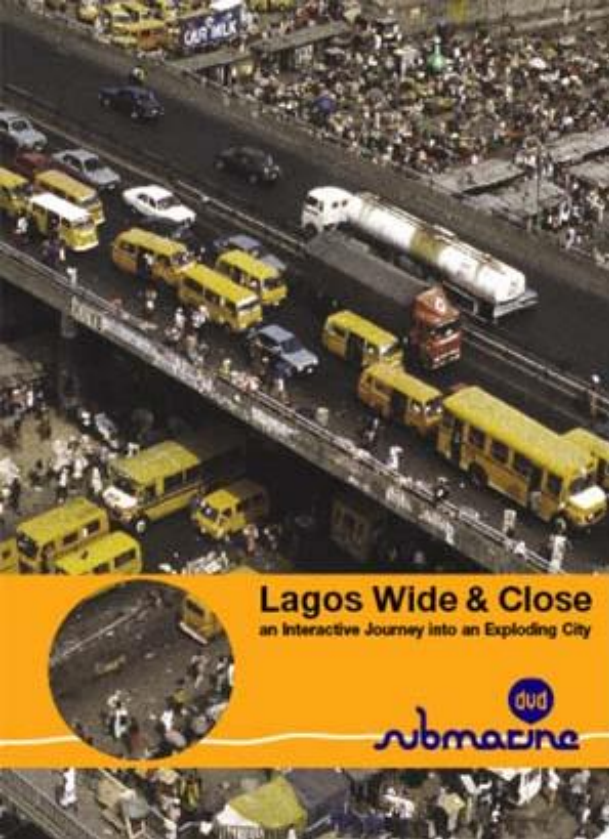
The Contested City (Jerusalem), the City of Exclusions and the politics of enclosures

Generic Megacities (China), Urban Villages and the Chinese rapid urbanization

The Logistics City (Dubai), the Enclave City and the City of Flows (goods and migrants)

The Tourist City (Havana and Mumbai) and the ethics of sightseeing

The Smart City of the Global South (Rio de Janeiro, Songdo, Masdar, and more)



- *Unable to travel around the world to visit the variety of cities the course discusses the class is reliant on cinema: each week's readings are supplemented with films.*

Course Requirements:

1/ Weekly attendance in lecture and participation in precept discussions on assigned readings and viewings including weekly posting of images for precept discussion [1/3rd of final grade].

2/ Mid-Term Assignment: take home examination on lecture topics, *required readings and viewings of first six weeks [1/3rd of final grade].

3/ Final Assignment: take home examination on topics related to *required readings and viewings of last six weeks [1/3rd of final grade].



WHY. DO CITIES MATTER in the ANTHROPOCENE ERA?

The atmospheric chemist Paul Crutzen (1933-2021) coined the term ‘**Anthropocene**’ in 2000 as both an epoch and a dilemma. He thought the complex Earth System had moved away from its **relative stability of the Holocene** epoch to a less stable, more violent, and still uncertain phase around **1950**. Mid- century is when human population, economic activity and greenhouse gas emissions began to skyrocket globally leaving traces on the ground and in ice caps of plutonium isotopes from **nuclear explosions, nitrogen from fertilizers, ash from power plants**. Subsequently, the air has become more polluted and hotter, sea levels are rising and flooding coastal areas, global biodiversity is shrinking, fresh water is diminishing, topsoil is being exploited. In short, the **systems that offer food, shelter, fuel for existence are under intense pressure lurching toward unstable conditions**, crises followed by systemic shifts toward breakdown or reassemble. The causes are the many **anthropogenetic forces transforming every part of the planet** from local to planetary scales from short term to long term effects. These are troubled times that require **disaster management and resilient strategies** against future changes.

The Anthropocene era is usually associated with the planet’s **rapid rate of urbanization** – some even refer to this conflation as the **urbicene**. Since 1950, the world’s population living in cities has doubled in size. It is projected by 2050, **68% of the Earth’s** population will live within cities.

Cities are giant machines sucking in energy and spewing out waste. They generate as much as **three-quarters of human energy consumption and carbon emissions**. Their industries have **polluted the water, air and soil**. Many of the world's cities are **in coastal regions** prone to environmental disasters and hazards. **Cities are vulnerable to the ravages of the Anthropocene epoch.**

Be they dense in size or sprawled across rural hinterlands, with population growing, shrinking or plateauing, located in capitals of finance or bankrupted regions, belonging to emerging or industrialized nations – **the equitable and inclusive management of urban areas is one of the most important challenges facing the 21st century.**

Massive urbanization has produced in its wake **‘megacities’ of more than 20 million residents** such as **Dhaka, Tokyo, Delhi, Shanghai, Mexico City, Mumbai, and Sao Paulo**. These megacities, most of which are in the global South, face major challenges in the supply of water, food, clean air, land, infrastructure, housing, energy, sanitation, transportation, jobs, healthcare facilities, and schools.

Simultaneously, in some large cities located in the developed regions of the global North, population is expected **to decline** in the next ten years by 17%. Manufacturing shifts, demographic changes, technological innovations, and natural disasters are some of the factors leading **to shrinkage in cities** as diverse as **New Orleans, Detroit, Cleveland, Prague, Bucharest, Odessa, St. Petersburg, Genoa, Venice and Manchester**. Cities will need to respond to the realities of either **overwhelming expansion or disastrous shrinkage.**

Cities confront **climate-related risks** of breakdown in their services and infrastructure that will affect other variables of the urban complexity unless bold planning and action are taken. Ineffective responses in areas of **high urban growth rates often result in spirals of urban poverty and the formation of massive slums or informal settlements**. Prosperous cities may be **artistic hubs, tourist attractors, high-tech centers, financial capitals, environmental innovators, and public transit providers**. But they generate problems of **gentrification and affordable housing**, lopsided real estate speculation and gated communities. **Austerity** measures contracting municipal **budgets** and private **market investments in urban services** tend to deliver uneven solutions even for well-off cities, neglecting some areas while benefiting others.

How should the complex set of problems confronting cities be approached in the 21st century? How do we arrive at a concept of an **‘equitable’ city** as the disequilibria and dislocations of the global economy are negotiated across the range and typology of cities?

Is it possible **to plan for growth as well as decline**? What are the **environmental advantages of cities**? Is the process of **urbanization** irreversible and rural shrinkage inevitable? What are **the challenges of communication technology on the future of cities**? Are there governmental or institutional structures to mediate **and manage urban conflicts over scarce resources, gentrification of communities, or vulnerability to risks**?

PART 1 AMERICAN CITIES IN THE 21ST CENTURY

Week 1 CITY OF RISK/ CITY OF RETREAT – Miami, Florida



Week 1 City of Risk/City of Retreat – Miami Florida:

***Required Reading and Viewing:**

Week 1 City of Risk/City of Retreat – Miami Florida

***Required Reading and Viewing:**

*Jeff Goodwell Chapter 11 “Miami is Drowning,” *The Water will Come- Rising Seas, Sinking Cities, and the Remaking of Civilized Cities* (New York: Little, Brown and Company, 2017), 332-370.

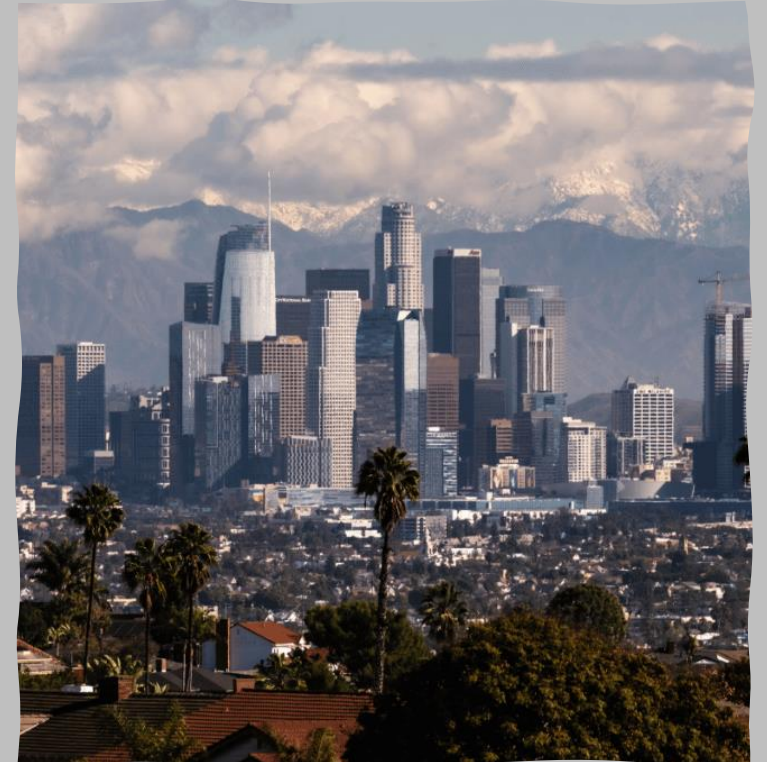
*Stefanie Wakefield, **Chapter 4** “Beyond Resilience,- Islands, Urbicide, and Infrastructural Delinking,” *Miami in the Anthropocene – Rising Seas and Urban Resilience* (Minneapolis: University of Minnesota Press, 2024), 135 – 167, 254 - 264. [Kindle]

Background Reading:

Abraham Lustgarten, “The People Fleeing Climate Disasters Are Going to Transform the American South.” *The New York Times* (Oct. 2, 2024).

Stefanie Wakefield, Chapter 10 “Urbicide in the Anthropocene Imagining Miami Futures,” in Earl T. Harper and Doug Specht (Eds.) *Imagining Apocalyptic Politics in the Anthropocene* (New York and London: Routledge, 2022), 173-188.

Week 2 THE CITY OF SPRAWL/ THE CITY OF THE AMERICAN DREAM --- Los Angeles



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***Required Reading and Viewing:**

The Effects of Sprawl:

1/ Los Angeles is “72 suburbs in search of a city,” [Dorothy Parker]:

*Becky M. Nicolaides, Chapter 7 “From Neighborhood Trust to Neighborhood Watch: Lakewood,” (New York: Oxford University Press, 2024), 451-636, 696-720. <read >

*Rosecrans Baldwin, “LESSON 1 Anything Can Happen at Any Second The United States of Los Angeles,” and “LESSON 4 Everything That Has Happened Here Will Happen Here Again,”
Everything Now Lessons from the City-State of Los Angeles (New York: Farrar, Straus and Giroux. Kindle Edition, 2021), 1-11, 94-128.

2/ The American Dream of Owning a Single-Family Home:

George J. Sanchez, “Chapter 6 “Generations of Segregation – Immigrant Dreams and Segregated Lives in Metropolitan Los Angeles,” in John Tutino & Martin V. Melosi (eds.) *New World Cities Challenges of Urbanization and Globalization in the Americas* (Chapel Hill and London: University of North Carolina Press, 2019), 210-242.

3/ Chasing the American Dream in Los Angeles:

Susanna Rosenbaum, Chapter 1 “Producing In/Visibility in Los Angeles,” *Domestic Economies: Women, Work, and the American Dream in Los Angeles* (Durham and London: Duke University Press, 2017), 27 – 48. Kindle Edition.

4/ The City made for Automobiles:

Stefan Bratzel, Chapter 7 “Back to the Future: L.A. Revisited 1990-2022,” *Extremes of Mobility: Development and Consequences of Transport Policy in Los Angeles* (World Science, 2023), 131-150.

Films:

*What it Takes to Make a Home (CCA Documentary, 2019)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=r83X-mtHt8o>

Background Reading:

Vinit Mukhija, Chapter 3 “City of Dreams: Single-Family Housing and Second Units in Los Angeles,” *Remaking the American Dream: The Informal and Formal Transformation of Single-Family Housing Cities* (Cambridge: The MIT Press, 2022), 61-94.

Paul Haddad, “Begin Freeway,” *Freewaytopia How Freeways Shaped Los Angeles* (Santa Monica CA.: Santa Monica Press, Kindle Edition, 2021), 15 – 28, 357-358

Week 3 THE CITY OF AUSTERITY and BLACK LIVES MATTER — Detroit



Week 3 THE CITY OF AUSTERITY and BLACK LIVES MATTER --- Detroit

***Required Reading and Viewing:**

1/ Do Black Cityscapes Matter?:

*Michelle Anderson, Chapter 4 “Do not Bid – Detroit Michigan,” *The Fight to Save the Town Reimagining Discarded America* (New York, London: Avid Reader Press, 2022), 139-174.

Andre M. Perry, Chapter 2 “A Father Forged in Detroit,” *Know Your Price – Valuing Black Lives and Property in America’s Black Cities* (Washington D.C.: Brookings Institution, 2020), 42-74, 218-222.

2/ Land Grabs and Land Justice in Detroit:

*Sara Safransky, Chapter 8 “The Garden is a Weapon of War,” *The City after Property – abandonment and repair in postindustrial Detroit* (Durham and London: Duke University Press, 2023), 169-196, 251-256.

Sara Safransky, “Land Justice as a Historical Diagnostic: Thinking of Detroit,” *Annals of American Association of Geography* (2017), 1 – 14.

Andrew Herscher, “Introduction,” *The Unreal Estate Guide to Detroit* (Ann Arbor, MI: University of Michigan Press, 2012), 6 – 21. < <http://dx.doi.org/10.3998/dcbooks.12103229.0001.001>

3/ The Spectacle of Revitalization in

* Roger Biles and Mark Rose, ““Gilbertville,” “Ilitchville,” and the Redevelopment of Detroit,” *Journal of Planning History* 20, 1 (2021), 3-27.

L. Owen Kirkpatrick and Chalem Bolton, Chapter Two “Austerity and the Spectacle- Urban Triage and Post-Political Development in Detroit, , in Mark Davidson and Kevin Ward (ed.) *Cities under Austerity: Restructuring the US Metropolis* (Albany: SUNY Press, 2018), 27 – 58.

4/ Picturing Detroit:

Wes Aelbrecht, Chapter 13 “Detroit. Move Here. Move the World: Constructing Detroit in Photobooks,” in Davide Deriu and Angelo Maggi *Picturing Cities The Photobook as Urban Narrative* (Milan: FrancoAngeli, 2016), 191-203.

Films:

*Land Grab (Sean King O’Grady, 2018)

A People’s Story of Detroit (#detroitpeoples, 2015)

Background Reading: Detroit - A City of Ruins

Dora Apel, Chapter 2 “Fear and Longing in Detroit,” *Beautiful Terrible Ruins Detroit and the Anxiety of Decline* (New Brunswick, N.J. and London: Rutgers University Press, 2015) Kindle loc612 –1325, loc3388- 3644

Vonne Audirac, “Shrinking cities: An unfit term for American Urban Policy?” *Cities* 75 (20018), 12 -19.

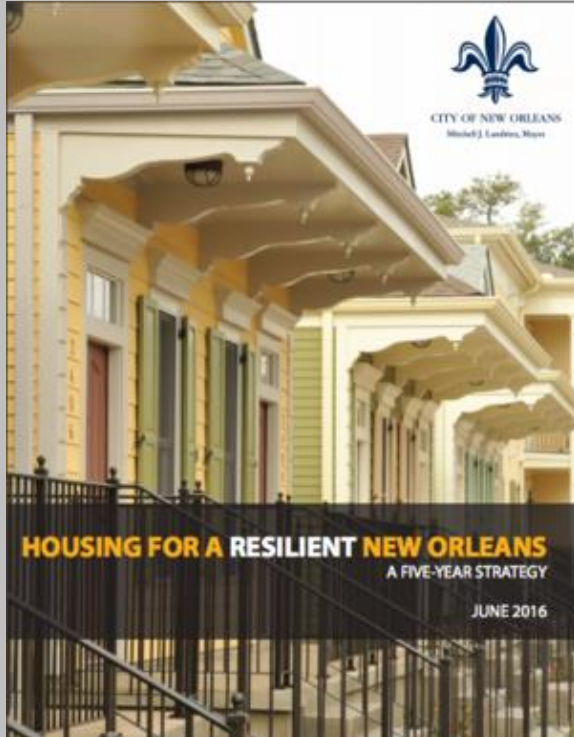
Emma Fraser, “Unbecoming place: Urban Imaginaries in Transition in Detroit,” *cultural geographies* 25, 2 (2018), 441-458.

Rebecca J. Kinney Chapter 4 “Flickers of the American Dream Filming Possibility in Decline” *Beautiful Wasteland The Rise of Detroit as America’s Postindustrial Frontier* (Minneapolis: Minnesota University Press, 2016), Kindle loc2134-loc2676; loc4106 – loc4223

Jamie Peck, “Austerity urbanism” *City: analysis of urban trends, culture, theory, policy, action* 16, 6 (2012): 625 - 655.

Sarah Phinney, “Detroit’s Municipal Bankruptcy: Racialised Geographies of Austerity,” *New Political Economy* 23, 5 (2018), 609-626.

Week 4 THE RESILIENT CITY/THE CITY AT RISK--- New Orleans



Week 4 THE RESILIENT CITY/THE CITY AT RISK--- New Orleans

***Required Reading and Viewing:**

1 Engineering Resilience

*Kevin Grove, Chapter 2 “Resilience as Essentially a Contested Concept,” *Resilience* (New York and London: Routledge, 2018), 30 – 64, Read 30 – 42.

2 Resilient Communities

*Alison Sant, 4 “New Orleans: Living with Water,” *From the Ground Up Local Efforts to Create Resilient Cities* (Washington D. C. : Island Press, 2022), 73-90, 250-253.

Zachary Lamb and Lawrence Vale, “Part 1 Environment – Equitably resilience Environments: Knowledge, Protections,, and Ecological Vitality; Case 1 Gentilly Resilience District, Ambitions Aims and Political Perils in Post-Katrina New Orleans,” *The Equitably Resilient City* (Cambridge: The MIT Press, 2024 Kindle Edition), 31-47, 47-67.

Patrick Naef, “Resistances in the ‘Resilient City’: Rise and fall of a disputed concept in New Orleans and Medellin,” *Political Geography* 96 (2022), 1-10.

3 Don't Call me Resilient!

*Kyo McClear, “Something So Broken: Black Care in the Wake of *Beasts of the Southern Wild*, “*ISLE: Interdisciplinary Studies in Literature and Environment* 25, 3 (Summer 2018), 603–629.

Annie Stopford, Chapter 6 “Y’all know it’s not fixed,” *Trauma and Repair Confronting Segregation and Violence in America* (Lathan, Boulder, New York, London: Lexington Books, 2023), 119-140.

Anna Hartnell, “Writing the Liquid City: Excavating Urban Ecologies after Katrina,” *Textual Practices* 31, 5 (2017), 933-949.

Laura McTighe with Deon Haywood, “Front Porch Revolution: Resilience Space, Demonic Grounds, and the Horizons of a Black Feminist Otherwise,” *Signs: Journal of Women in Culture and Society* 44, 1 (2018), 25 – 52.

Skim through these reports:

*Climate Action for a Resilient New Orleans” (City of New Orleans, July 2017) <https://nola.gov/resilience/climate-action/>

**Greater New Orleans Urban Water Plan Vision Report*_(31Oct2013).
http://livingwithwater.com/blog/urban_water_plan/reports/ SKIM

Films:

**Beasts of the Southern Wild* (Benh Zeitlin, 2012)

Getting Back to Abnormal (Louis Alvarez, Andreas Kolker, Peter Oddabashian, Paul Stekler, 2014)

Background Reading:

Min Hee Go, Chapter 1 “Resilient Communities in a Vulnerable City,” *Rethinking Community Resilience The Politics of Disaster Recovery in New Orleans* (New York: New York University Press, 2021 Kindle Edition [loc570-loc958])

Cedric Johnson, “Watching the Train Wreck or Looking for the Brake?” *Souls A Critical Journal of Black Politics, Culture, and Society* 14, 3-4 (2012), 207-226.

Cedric Johnson, “Gentrifying New Orleans: Thoughts on Race and the Movement of Capital,” *Souls A Critical Journal of Black Politics, Culture, and Society* 17, 3-4 (2015), 75-200.

Zachary Lamb, Chapter 3 “Connecting the Dots: The Origins, Evolutions, and Implications of the Map that Changed Post-Katrina Recovery Planning in New Orleans,” in Shirley Laska (ed.) *Louisiana’s Response to Extreme Weather A Coastal State’s Adaptation Challenges and Successes* (Springer Open Access Books, 2020), 65-92.

Peter Marcuse, “Ignoring Injustice in Disaster Planning” *The Urban Reinventors Papers*

Series ©2005 -©-2009 *The Right to the City: the Entitled and the Excluded* Issue 3, 9 (2005-©-2009): 1 –

Peter J. Marina, Chapter 8 “Gentrification and Violent Cultural Resistance,” *Down and Out in New Orleans Transgressive Living in the Informal Economy* (New York: Columbia University Press, 2017), loc3693-loc 4138, loc5327-loc5428.

John C. Mutter, Chap 6 “Struck Dumb By New Orleans,” and Chap 7 “Rebuilding as Social Engineering,” *The Disaster Profiteers How Natural Disasters Make the Rich Richer and the Poor Even Poorer* (New York: St. Martin’s Press, 2015), 159 – 188, 181 – 209, 265- 270, 270-272.

Mark Neocleous, Commentary “Resisting Resilience” *Radical Philosophy* 178, 6 (March/April 2013), 1- 6.

Lawrence Vale and Thomas Campanella “Conclusion: Axioms of Resilience” in Lawrence Vale (ed.) *The Resilient City* (New York: Oxford University Press, 2001): 335 – 355.

Week 5 THE GENTRIFIED CITY/THE TECH CITY --- San Francisco



Week 5 THE GENTRIFIED CITY/THE TECH CITY --- San Francisco

***Required Reading and Viewing:**

1 The Gentrified City: San Francisco's Mission District:

*Matthew Schuerman, Chapter 10 “Zero-Sum Game, San Francisco, 2001-2018,” *Newcomers -Gentrification and its Discontents* (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2019), 210-236, notes 309-313.

Kipp Pietrantonio, Jasmin D. Llamas, and Keither McIntosh, Chapter 4 “A Mural Cannot Replace Us: Immigrants, Gentrification, and Displacement,” in F. M. Moghaddam and M. J. Hendricks (eds.) *Contemporary Immigration: Psychological Perspectives to Address Challenged and Inform Solutions* (American Psychological Association, 2022), 63-79.

2 The Tech City: San Francisco

*Manissa M. Maharawal, “Infrastructural Activism: Google Bus Blockades, Affective Politics, and Environmental Gentrification in San Francisco” *Antipode* 53 (2021), 1 – 25.

Rebecca Solnit, “Diary_ Get off the Bus” *London Review of Books* 36, 4 (Feb. 20, 2014)
<https://www.lrb.co.uk/the-paper/v36/n04/rebecca-solnit/diary>

Lucie Green, “Introduction: A Changing Landscape,” *Silicon Stories: The Power and Politics of Big Tech and What it Means for our Future* (Berkeley: Counterpoint, 2018), 8-44.

3 The Last Black Man in San Francisco:

*S Klawans, Review “The Last Black Man in San Francisco,” *Film Comment* 55 ,3 (May/June 2019), 68.9.

Films:

**The Last Black Man in San Francisco* (Joe Talbot, 2019)

San Francisco 2.0 (Alexandra Pelosi, 2015)

Mission Playground is not for sale (YouTube, 2014) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=awPVY1DcupE>

Background Reading:

Kate Lyons, “Let’s Get Phygital- Seeing the Filter Landscape of Instagram,” *Linguistic Landscape* 5, 2 (2019), 179-197.

Manissa M. Maharawal, Chapter 3 “San Francisco’s Tech-Led Gentrification Public Space, Protest and the Urban Commons,” in Jeffrey Hou and Sabine Knierbein (eds.) *City Unsilenced: Urban Resistance and Public Space in the Age of Shrinking Democracy* (New York and London: Routledge, 2017), 30-43.

Richard A. Walker, Chapter 5 “The New Urbanism Remaking the Heart of the City,” *Pictures of a Gone City: Tech and the Dark Side of Prosperity in San Francisco Bay Area* (Oakland: PM Press, 2018), 153-192.

Week 6 THE GREEN CITY /THE ENVIRONMENTALLY JUST CITY--- New York City



NY'S GREEN AMENDMENT

And What It Means for Environmental Justice

Week 6 THE GREEN CITY /THE ENVIRONMENTALLY JUST CITY--- New York City

***Required Reading and Viewing:**

1 Landscape Urbanism and the High Line of New York City:

*Aleksandr Bierig, “The High Line And Other Myths.” *Log*, no. 18 (2010), 129–34.

Nate Millington, “From urban scar to ‘park in the sky’: *Terrain Vague*, Urban Design, and the remaking of New York City’s High Line Park,” *Environment and Planning a* 47 (2015), 1 – 15.

David Halle and Elisabeth Tiso, Chapter 3 “The High Line,” *New York’s New Edge Contemporary Art, the High Line, and Urban Megaprojects on the Far West Side* (Chicago: The University of Chicago Press, 2014), loc2979-loc3524, loc8073-loc8106.

Natalie Gulsrud & Henriette Steiner, “When urban greening becomes an accumulation strategy: exploring the ecological, social and economic calculus of the High Line,” *Journal of Landscape Architecture*, 14:3, 82-87.

2 Environmental Justice and Toxic sites Newtown Creek, Brooklyn: Just Green Enough

* Winifred Curran and Trina Ham, “A Just Enough Green? Industrial Gentrification and Competing socio-natures in Greenpoint, Brooklyn,” in Winifred Curran and Trina Hamilton (eds.) *Just Green Enough Urban Development and Environmental Gentrification* (New York and London: Routledge, 2018), loc1309 – loc1623.

Winifred Curran and Trina Hamilton, “Reworking Newtown Creek,” in Robert Krueger, Time Freytag, and Samuel Mossner, (eds.) *Adventures in Sustainable Urbanism* (Albany: States University of New York Press, 2019), 1 -92.

Carl A. Zimring, Chapter 12, :”Reading Newtown Creek: Competing Narrative of New York City Aquatic Discardscapes,” in Carl A. Zimring and Steven H. Corey (eds.) *Coastal N=Metropolis Environmental Histories of Modern New York City* (Pittsburg: University of Pittsburgh Press, 2021), 173-189, 235.

3 Transforming Wasteful landfills into Freshkills Park:

*Benjamin A. Lawson, Chapter 5 “Representing Rehabilitation,” *A Cultural History of Waste Disposal: Environmental Policy and Park Redevelopment* ((New York and London: Routledge, 2024), 131-163.

*Philip Hutchinson, “ Exploring the Connection between Landscape and Biopolitics: The Story of Freshkills Park,” *Landscape Review* 17, 1 (2016?), 96-107.

Julie Sze, Chp 4 “The Racial Geography of New York City Garbage: Local and Global Trash Politics,” *Noxious New York the Racial Politics of Urban Health and Environmental Justice* (MIT Press, 2007): Loc1318 – Loc1701, Loc2620 – Loc2749.

Field Operations ‘Lifescape’, Fresh Kills Park: Draft Master Plan, Field Operations 2006,
<http://www.nyc.gov/html/dcp/pdf/fkl/dmp.pdf>

Martin V. Melosi, Part IV “The Post-Closure Era” Chapters 18, 19, 20 and Conclusion and Relevant Notes,” *Fresh Kills - A History of Consuming and Discarding in New York City* (New York: Columbia University Press, 2020), 464-555, 727-757.

Film:

Fresh Kills, Staten Island Then and Now (March 24 2010)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?time_continue=1&v=YxPJYiZNFGg

“Where does New York City’s Trash Go?/ Living City/ The New York Times (September 25, 2014)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Y6LzB6rMDtA>

“From Freshkills Landfill to Fresh Kills Park” NYC Sanitation Department (2022)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-BudHP6IG0c>

*Fresh Kills: From Landfill to Park in Staten Island (2012)

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Lbm_K5JKkYI

•The Fresh Kills Story: From World’s Largest Garbage Dump to a World Class Park”

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3hMhWOaX_0o

“Introduction to Superfund” [Newtown Creek Alliance, 10 21 2020]

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=klO1hJBjns>

“Newtown Creek Nature Walk Overview” [Newtown Creek Alliance, 10 21 2020]

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aYhRfwTBpYM>

Background Reading:

James Corner, “Terra Fluxus,” in Charles Waldheim (ed.) *The Landscape Urbanism Reader* (New York: Princeton Architectural Press, 2006), 22-33.

May Joseph, Chapter 7 “Greening Hardscape,” *Fluid New York Cosmopolitan Urbanism and the Green Imagination* (Durham/London: Duke University Press, 2013), 133 – 150, 225-226.

Martin V. Melosi *Fresh Kills - A History of Consuming and Discarding in New York City* (New York: Columbia University Press, 2020).

Pier Luigi Sacco, Maria Tartari, Guido Ferilli & Giorgio Tavano Blessi, “Gentrification as space domestication. The High Line Art Case.” *Urban Geography* (2018), 1 – 26.

Frederick Steiner “Landscape Ecological Urbanism: Origins and trajectories” *Landscape and Urban Planning* 100 (2011): 333 – 337.

Charles Waldheim *Landscape as Urbanism A General Theory* (New York: Princeton Architectural Press, 2016).



- **MIDTERM TAKE HOME EXAMINATION:** handed out in class 2:45pm Week 7, due one week later at 1:20pm Week 8.

- Think of the words: Anthropocene, Retreat, Sprawl, The American Dream, Austerity, Black Lives Matter, Resilient, Gentrification, Environmental Justice

- **Part II CITIES OF THE GLOBAL SOUTH IN THE 21ST CENTURY**
- **Week 7 THE INFORMAL CITY and the GLOBAL SOUTH - Lagos**



Week 7 THE INFORMAL CITY and the Global South - Lagos

***Required Reading and Viewing:**

1 The Global South

Pascal Clerc and Andre Reyes Novaes, Chapter 11 “The North-South Problem in Geography” in Vladimir Kolosov, Jacobo Garcia-Ivarez, Michael Heffernan, Bruno Schelhaas (eds.) *A Geographical Century- Essays for a Centenary of the International Geographical Union* (Cham Switzerland, 2022), 155-165.

2 How to define informal/formal?

Monika Grubbauer, “In search of Authenticity,” *City* 21, 6 (2017), 189-199.

3 What does informality have to do with Architecture?

* Joseph Godlewski “Alien and Distant: Rem Koolhaas on Film in Lagos, Nigeria” *TDSD* 21, 11 (2010): 7 – 19.

*Tim Hecker, “The Slum Pastoral: Helicopter Visuality and Koolhaas’s Lagos,” *Space and Culture* 13, 3 (2010): 256-269.

Rem Koolhaas, “Lagos” in Rem Koolhaas, et al (eds.) *Mutations* (Barcelona: Actar, 2000): 650 – 719.

4 Films:

*Lagos Wide & Close: An interactive Journey into an Exploding City (Bregtje van der Haak, 2005)
Lagos/Koolhaas (Bregtje van der Haak, 2003)

Background Reading:

Kim Dovey and Ross Koing, “Forms of Informality: Morphology and Visibility of Informal Settlements” *Built Environment* 37, 1 (2011): 11 – 29.

Matthew Gandy, “Learning from Lagos” *New Left Review* 33 (May-June 2005), 36 – 52.

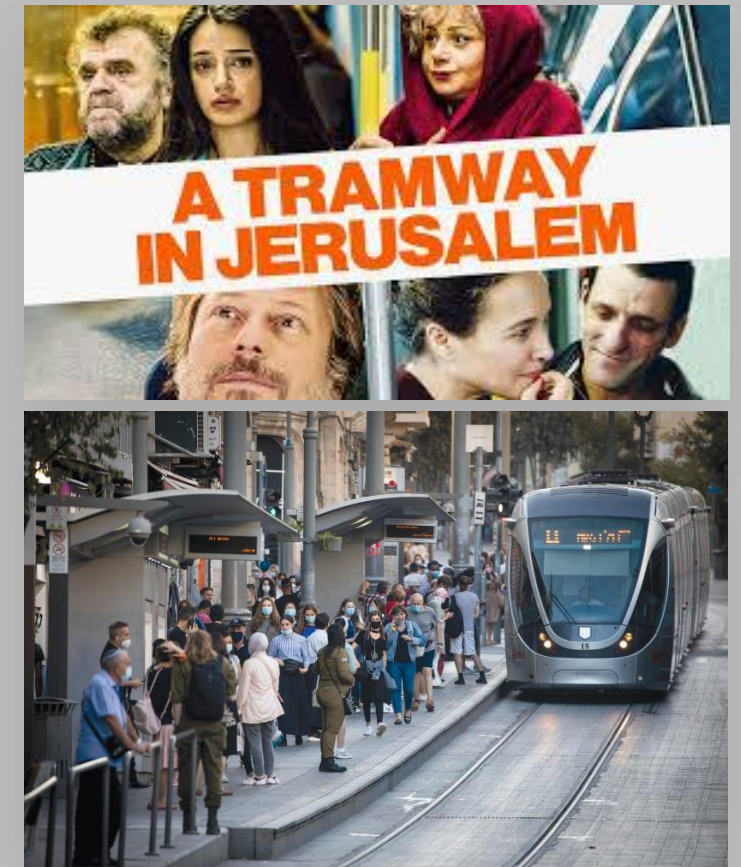
Matthew Gandy, “Planning, Anti-planning and the Infrastructure Crisis Facing Metropolitan Lagos,” *Urban Studies* 43, 2 (2006): 371 – 396.

Jeff Goodell, Chapter 10 “Climate Apartheid,” *The Water Will Come Rising Seas, Sinking Cities, and the Remaking of the Civilized World* (New York: Little, Brown and Company, 2017), 213 – 231.

Stephanie Jewel, Chapter 7 “Remembering the Waste,” *Histories of Dirt: Media and Urban Life in Colonial and Postcolonial Lagos* (Durham and London: Duke University Press, 2020), Loc 2846 -3466, Loc 5634-5927.

George Packer, “Megacity” *The New Yorker* (November 13, 2006): 62 - 68.

Week 8 THE DIVIDED CITY/ THE CONTESTED CITY --- Jerusalem



Week 8 THE DIVIDED CITY/ THE CONTESTED CITY --- Jerusalem

***Required Reading and Viewing:**

1 Divided and Contested Jerusalem: The case of Silwan and the City of David

*Andrew Lawler, “Under Jerusalem,” *National Geographic* 236, Issue 6 (Dec 2019), 40, 42, 46, 50-51, 60, 62-63, 66-67.

*Susan Greene, “I Witness Silwan Who is watching Whom?” *Jerusalem Quarterly* 82 (Summer, 2022), 154-167.

Penny Johnson, “Are You Coming with a Bulldozer to Silwan?” *Jerusalem Quarterly* 82 (Summer, 2020), 168-173.

Mahmoud Hawari, “Silwan,” *Colonialism -Biblical Archaeology, Cultural Appropriation, and Settler Colonialism,*” *Jerusalem Quarterly* 90 (Summer 2022), 75-97.

Joel Stokes, ““Silence,” Heritage, and Sumud in Silwan, East Jerusalem, *Jerusalem Quarterly* 91 (Autumn 2022) 105-120.

Susan Greene, “I Witness Silwan: Public Art, Tourism, and International Solidarity in Palestinian East Jerusalem,, “ROOM: A Sketchbook for Analytic Action|6.24 <https://analytic-room.com/community-projects/i-witness-silwan/>

Marion Lecoquierre Chapter 1 “Three sites of contention - Al-Araqib, Silwan, Hebron” *Emplaced Resistance in Palestine and Israel* (New York and London : Routledge, 2022), 66 --- 128, read 97-106.

2 The Meaning of ‘house/home’ in Jerusalem: The Films of Amos Gitai

Barbara Mann, “House Interrupted,” *Michigan Quarterly Review* 54, 1 (Winter 2015), 87-97.

3 Shared Spaces - A Tramway to Unite Jerusalem

*Marik Shtern and Jonathan Rokem , “Towards Urban Geopolitics of Encounter: Spatial Mixing in Contested Jerusalem,” *Geopolitics* 28, 5 (2023), 1710-1734.

Michelle U. Campos, “The Jerusalem Light Rail in Historical Perspective Urban Transportation and Urban Citizenship between Ottomanism and Apartheid, “ *Jerusalem Quarterly* 92 (Winter 2022), 52- 68.

Nitzan Faibish , Noam Brenner and Dan Miodownik, “Third space and spontaneous contact in a divided city: evidence from Jerusalem. PEACEBUILDING <https://doi.org/10.1080/21647259.2024.2430863>

4 Films:

**Tramway in Jerusalem* (Amos Gitai, 2018; released 2020)

House/A House in Jerusalem (Amos Gitai, 1979, 1998)

Resilient Jerusalem Series 1, Episode 7 (Amazon Prime Video Release date April 26, 2018)

<https://www.amazon.com/Resilient-Cities/dp/B07CT6DPQV>

Background Reading:

Stephen Graham, “Cities and the ‘War on Terror’”, in Michael Sorkin (ed.) *Indefensible Space The Architecture of the National Insecurity State* (New York: Routledge 2008);1 -29.

Stephen Graham, “Ubiquitous Borders” and “Lessons in Urbicide” *Cities under Siege The New Military Urbanism* (London: Verso 2011): 89-152, 226 – 262.

Andrew Herscher, Chapter 3 “Designs on Disaster: Humanitarianism and Contemporary Architecture,” *The Routledge Companion to Critical Approaches to Contemporary Architecture* Swati Chattopadhyay and Jeremy White (London and New York: Routledge, 2018), 25 – 35.

Andrew Lawler *Under Jerusalem: The Buried History of the World’s Most Contested City* (New York: Doubleday, 2021).

Jeremy Pressman, “Horizontal Inequality and Violent Unrest in Jerusalem,” *Journal of Terrorism and Political Violence* 32, 6 (2020), 1161-1185.]

Anne B. Shlay and Gillad Rosen, Chap 5 “The Palestinian Challenge and Resistance in Arab Jerusalem,” *Jerusalem The Spatial Politics of a Divided Metropolis* (Cambridge: Polity Press, 2015), 137-163,

Eyal Weizman, “The Art of War” *Freize*, 99 May 2006.

Week 9 THE MEGACITIES OF CHINA--- Shanghai, Beijing and Shenzhen



Week 9 THE MEGACITIES OF CHINA--- Shanghai, Beijing and Shenzhen

***Required Reading and Viewing:**

1 China's Urban Revolution:

*Thomas J. Campanella, "Introduction--The Urbanism of Ambition," Chapter 2 "Reclaiming Shanghai," *The Concrete Dragon: China's Urban Revolution and What it Means for the World* (New York: PAP Press, 2008) ,13-26, 57-92, Notes 303-304, 306-309.

* Tom Miller Chapter 1 "By the Sweat of Their Brows: The People who built Urban China," *China's Urban Billion The Story behind the Biggest migration in Human History* (London/New York: Zed Books, 2012), Loc218-Loc572.

2 Shenzhen Special Economic Zone (SEZ):

*Urbanus (ed.) "City Files," *Urban Village Coexistence* (Shanghai: Shanghai Culture Publishing House, 2024), 38 – 113.

Juan Du. Chapter 2 "The 'Southern Tour' that Changed China," *The Shenzhen Experiment The Story of China's Instant City* (Cambridge: Harvard University Press, 2020), 50 – 87, Notes 322-327.

3 Films:

**Manufactured Landscapes* (Edward Burtynsky and Jennifer Baichwai, 2006)

Clemens von Wedemeyer and Maya Schweizer *Metropolis, View from China* (2006)

<https://loop-barcelona.com/videocloop/video/metropolis-report-from-china/>

Why China is Building Their Own Europe? <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=5l4uGv9Tg28>

Background Reading:

David Bandurski, “Introduction,” *Dragons in Diamond Village: Tales of Resistance from Urbanizing China* (London: Melville House, 2016) Kindle Loc142-Loc424, Loc3717-Loc3897.

Weiwen Huang, Chapter 3 “The Tripartite Origins of Shenzhen: Beijing, Hong Kong, and Bao’an,” in Mary Ann O’Donnell, Winnie Wong and Jonathan Bach (eds.) *Learning from Shenzhen China’s Post-Mao Experiment from Special Zone to Model City* (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2017), Loc1639-Loc2083.

Mee Kam Ng and Wing-Shing Tang, “The Role of Planning in the Development of Shenzhen China: Rhetoric and Realities,” *Eurasian Geography and Economics* 5, 3 (2004), 190-211.

Da Wei David Wang, Chapter 6 “Urban Renewal and the Rise of Shenzhen’s Real Estate Developers,” *Urban Villages in the New China: Case of Shenzhen* (New York: Palgrave Macmillan, 2016), 109-124.

John Zacharias and Yuanzhou Tang, “Restructuring and Repositioning Shenzhen, China’s New Mega-City,” *Progress in Planning* 73 (2010), 209-249.

Week 10 THE LOGISTICS CITY/ THE ENCLAVE CITY -- Dubai



Week 10 THE LOGISTICS CITY/ THE ENCLAVE CITY --- Dubai

***Required Reading and Viewing:**

1 Logistics and the Port of Dubai:

Mina Akhavan, Chapter 7 “Gateway: Revisiting Dubai as a Port City,” In Harvey Molotch and Davide Ponzini (eds.) *The New Arab Urban* (New York: New York University Press, 2019), Loc 3533 – 3903.

2 Spectacular Dubai:

*Yasser Elsheshtawy, Chapter 10, “Real Estate Speculation and Transnational Development in Dubai,” In Harvey Molotch and Davide Ponzini (eds.) *The New Arab Urban* (New York: New York University Press, 2019), Loc 4747-5152.

*Cameron Hu, Chapter 5 “‘Where Everything is Political’ Architecture Against Politics in Global Dubai,” in Brian Spooner (ed.) *Globalization The Crucial Phase* (Philadelphia: University of Pennsylvania Museum of Archaeology and Anthropology, 2015), 143-171.

3 Who builds your architecture?

*Laavanya Kathiravelu Chap 2 “Dubai as Metaphor: Corporate Entity, Global City, Hope and Mirage,” *Migrant Dubai: Low wage Workers and The Construction of a Divided City* (New York: Palgrave Macmillan, 2016 Kindle Edition), loc 663-1245, Notes, 4728-4750.

4 FILMS:

Dubai 2023 (Daniel Marquardt, 2023) Video Duration 00.04.39

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bhvlis1oogY>

Dubai Travel Guide – 15 Experience You Must do in 2023 Video Duration 00.16.18.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=wlKic6yTUUs&t=14s>

Dark Side of Dubai – What they don't tell you (Interesting Flow, 2021) Video Duration 00.10.45

https://www.youtube.com/results?search_query=dubai+immigrants

The Dark Side of Dubai – The Dubai They Don't Want You to See or Know (Travel with Dr Awah, Video Duration 00.26.25 2023) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CUKNcVTXzl4&t=169s>

Background Reading:

Michele Acuto, “High-rise Dubai urban entrepreneurialism and the technology of symbolic power” *Cities* 27 (2010): 272-284.

Deborah Cowen, Chapter 5 “Logistics Cities The ‘Urban Heart’ of Empire, “*The Deadly Life of Logistics-- Mapping Violence in Global Trade* (Minneapolis/London: University of Minnesota Press, 2014), Kindle loc3059-loc3617. Read “Dubai and the Birth of the Logistics City,” loc3151-loc3336.

Keller Easterling, Chapter 1 “Zone” and Chapter 2 “Disposition,” *Extrastatecraft The Power of Infrastructure Space* (New York/London: Verso Press, 2014), Kindle loc264 – loc1511.

Chad Haines, “Cracks in the Façade: Landscape of Hope and Desire in Dubai ” in Ananya Roy and Aihwa Ong *Worlding Cities Asian Experiments and the Art of Being Global* (Oxford: Blackwell Publishing Ltd., 2011): 160 – 181.

Ahmed Kanna, Chapter 2 “‘Going South’ with the Starchitects”, *Dubai The City as Corporation* (Minneapolis and London: University of Minnesota Press, 2011), loc1083 – loc1442, notes loc3128 – 3163.

Harvey Molotch and Davide Ponzini, Chapter 3 “Enacting Exclusion in Contemporary Gulf Cities,” in Sophie Watson(ed.) *Social Justice in the City: Space, Materiality and the Normative* (London: Routledge, 2020), 26 -43.

Ted Reisz “Making Dubai A Process in Crisis” *Architectural Design* (2010): 38 – 43

Week 11 THE TOURIST CITY-- Havana and Mumbai (Dharavi)



Week 11 THE TOURIST CITY--- Havana and Mumbai

*Required Reading and Viewing:

1 Touring Havana, the city of Ruin:

*Helene Balslev Clausen & Mario Alberto Velázquez García, “The Tourism Model in Post-Castro Cuba: Tensions between Ideology and Economic Realities,” *Tourism Planning & Development* 15, 5 (2018), 551 – 566.

Joanna Kocsis, “Places to be young: The dispossession of public space in Old Havana,” *Urban Studies* (2024), 1 – 9.

Antonio Jose Ponte, Chapter 12 “La Habana: City and Archive,” in Anke Birkenmaier and Esther Whitfield (eds.) *Havana Beyond the Ruins* (Durham: Duke University Press, 2011), 249 – 269.

2 Slum Tourism in Dharavi, Mumbai:

*Melissa Nisbett, “Empowering the empowered? Slum tourism and the depoliticization of poverty,” *Geoforum* 85 (2017), 27 – 45.

Peter Dyson, “Slum Tourism: Representing and Interpreting ‘Reality’ in Dharavi, Mumbai,” in Fabian Frenzell and Ko Koens (eds.) *Tourism and the Geography of Inequality: the New Politics of Slumming* (New York and London: Routledge, 2014), 60 – 80.

4 Films:

**Havana: the new art of making ruins* (Florian Borchmeyer and Matthias Hentschler, 2006)

Resilient Havana Series 1 Episode 9 (Amazon Prime Video Release date April 26, 2018) <https://www.amazon.com/Resilient-Cities/dp/B07CT6DPQV>

**Mumbai: Maximum City Under Pressure* (Urban Think Tank U-TT Zurich (Arkus Kneer and Daniel Schwartz, 2014)),

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_4ELdcVZgYk&t=23s

Havana: From on High (Pedro Ruiz, 2021)

Background Reading:

Belmont Freeman, “History of the Present: Havana” *Places Journal* (December, 2014).

<https://placesjournal.org/article/history-of-the-present-havana/>

Bianca Freire-Medeiros, “Tourism in the Largest Favela in Latin America,” *Touring Poverty* (Chicago: University of Chicago Seagull Books, 2014), 2014): 74 – 110.

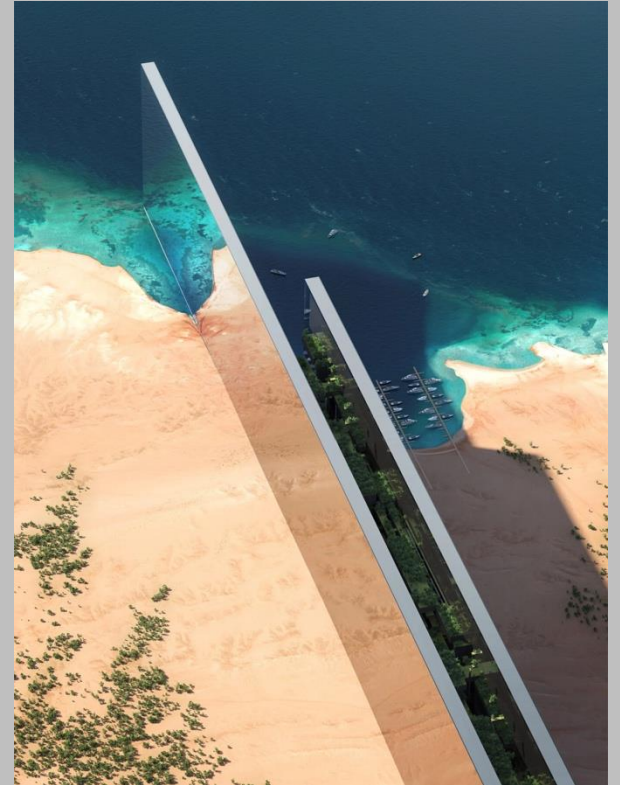
Fabian Frenzell, Ko Koens, and Malte Steinbrink (eds.) *Slum Tourism: Poverty, power, and ethics* (New York and London: Routledge, 2012).

Dean MacCannell, “The Tourist and the Urban Symbolic,” *The Ethics of Sight-seeing* (Berkeley: University of California Press 2011): 91-116, 241-243.

Manfred Rolfes “Poverty Tourism: theoretical reflections and empirical findings regarding an extraordinary form of tourism,” *GeoJournal* 75 (2010): 421-442.

Marita Sturken, “Architecture of Grief and the Aesthetics of Absence,” *Tourists of History Memory Kitsch, and Consumerism from Oklahoma City to Ground Zero* (Durham: Duke University Press, 2007): 219 – 286, 311 – 318.

Week 12 THE SMART CITY OF THE GLOBAL SOUTH --- Rio de Janeiro, Masdar, Songdo, 'The Line' in NEOM.



Week 12 THE SMART CITY OF THE GLOBAL SOUTH --- Rio de Janeiro, Masdar, Songdo, ‘The Line’ in NEOM.

***Required Reading and Viewing:**

1 It all started with Rio de Janeiro and IBM:

*Christopher Gaffney and Cerianne Robertson, “Smarter than Smart: Rio de Janeiro’s Flawed Emergence as a Smart City,” *Journal of Urban Technology* (2016), 1 – 16.

2 MASDAR Smart City in the Sand:

* Gökçe Günel, Chapter 1, “Inhabiting the Spaceship,” and Chapter 4, “An Expensive Toy,” *Spaceship in the Desert* (Durham: Duke University Press, 2019), 37-64, 2017-2013; 127-154, 226-331.

Federico Cugurullo, Chapter 4, “Speed kills: fast urbanism and endangered sustainability in the Masdar City Project,” in Ayona Datta and Abdul Shaban (eds.), *Mega-Urbanization in the Global South: Fast Cities and New Urban Utopias of the Postcolonial State* (London: Routledge, 2016), 66-80.

Frederico Cugurullo, “Urban eco-modernisation and the policy context of new eco-city projects: Where Masdar City fails and why,” *Urban Studies* 53, 11 (2016), 2417-2433.

3 SONGDO Smart city in South Korea:

*Orit Halpern, Jesse Le Cavalier, Nerea Calville, and Wolfgang Pietsch, “Test-Bed Urbanism” *Public Culture* 25 2 (2013), 273-306.

Hyun Bang Shin, Chapter 5 “Envisioned by the State: Entrepreneurial Urbanism and the Making of Songdo City, South Korea,” in Ayona Datta and Abdul Shaban (eds.), *Mega-Urbanization in the Global South: Fast Cities and New Urban Utopias of the Postcolonial State* (London: Routledge, 2016), 83-100.

4 ‘The Line’ in NEOM, Saudi Arabia [now canceled]

*Linda Kopitz, “AI Will Be the Beating Heart of the City”: Connectivity and/as Care in The Line,” *Media and Communication* 12 (2024) <https://doi.org/10.17645/mac.8181>

5 FILMS:

2057 Future City (2014)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qlYFvdr6yNM>

Cities of the Future Songdo South Korea (2011 Episodes 1, 2) https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fHO_zkHPTaI

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZufT4WozWeQ>

Building Green – Masdar City, Exploring the future. (2016)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=PfOVIhGuI4A>

Smarter Cities Rio/IBM Helps Rio Become a Smarter City (2011) <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t6NX8Lq7E8E>

‘The Line’ Saudi Arabia’s City of the Future in NEOM, (dr. Ben Hume-Paton, 2023)

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oamD9QoTH9M>

Background Reading:

Arup *Cities Alive Rethinking Cities in Arid Environments* (2018)

<https://www.arup.com/perspectives/publications/research/section/cities-alive-cities-in-arid-environments>

Frederico Cugurullo and David Ponzini, Chapter 10 “The transnational smart city as urban eco-modernisation: the case of Masdar City in Abu Dhabi,” ,” *Inside Smart Cities Place, Politics and Urban Innovation* (London and New York: Routledge, 2019), 149-161

Gökçe Günel, Chapter 8 “Exporting the Spaceship The Connected Isolation of Masdar City,” In Harvey Molotch and Davide Ponzini (eds.) *The New Arab Urban* (New York: New York University Press, 2019), Loc 3912- 4299.

Federico Cugurullo, “How to Build a Sandcastle: An Analysis of the Genesis and Development of Masdar City,” *Journal of Urban technology* (2013), 23 37.

- **Final Assignment:** take home examination on topics related to *required readings and viewings of last six weeks [1/3rd of final grade].

- Think of one of the following in the Global South: The Informal City, The Contested City, The Megacity, The Logistical City, The Tourist City, The Smart City

- **Due: Deans Date**

